Deon Grover

London grover.deon@outlook.com +44 7889 291964 https://github.com/DeGro19
https://portfolio-nine-roan-3b8pahbp36.vercel.app www.linkedin.com/in/deon-grover-447273291

Professional Summary

Cybersecurity graduate (1st Class Honours) from Keele University specialising in vulnerability detection, offensive security tooling, and cloud application security. Award-winning researcher whose dissertation extended OWASP ZAP with a custom payload library, increasing detected SQL injection vulnerabilities by 218% over the default payload set. Holds Microsoft AZ-204 (Azure Developer Associate), with hands-on experience across identity and access management, secrets handling with Key Vault, event-driven architecture and application monitoring, and keeps offensive skills current through TryHackMe labs covering SQL injection, XSS, privilege escalation and network-based attacks. Seeking a Junior Security Analyst role to apply research-led, cloud-aware methodologies to enterprise threat detection and secure application development.

Education

Keele University *Sept 2022 - July 2025*

BSc Computer Science (Cyber Security)

- Grade: 1st Class Honours
- Dissertation: "Enhancing SQL Injection Detection in OWASP ZAP using Custom Payload Fuzzing"
- Engineered a custom SQLi detection pipeline in OWASP ZAP using custom payload fuzzing
- Conducted structured vulnerability assessments using WebGoat environments
- Awarded Best Poster at Keele Town Hall; nominated Student of the Year 2025
- Dissertation co-publishing with Dr. Amro Al-Said Ahmad

Projects

Dissertation: SQLi Vulnerability Detection Enhancement in OWASP ZAP (Sept 2024 - July 2025)

- Built a context-aware payload library of 1,429 payloads covering Boolean, time-delay, error, union, blind, nested and encoded vectors, with obfuscation via Base64, Unicode and hexadecimal
- Increased detected SQL injection vulnerabilities by 218% against ZAP's default payload set (388 detections versus 122) in a controlled OWASP WebGoat testbed, and raised payload reflection rate from 18.7% to 27.2%
- Ran target and tooling in Docker for reproducible, isolated experiments, with Python automation exporting results to CSV and JSON for analysis
- Awarded Best Poster at Keele Town Hall; nominated Student of the Year 2025.

Microsoft Azure Cloud Application - "AZ-204 Developer Associate" (May 2026)

- Deployed and managed a scalable web application on Azure App Service, configuring SSL, API settings, diagnostics logging, and autoscaling rules for production-grade reliability
- Implemented identity and access controls using the Microsoft Identity Platform and Azure Active Directory, including OAuth 2.0 flows, shared access signatures, and role-based access control.
- Secured application secrets and credentials using Azure Key Vault, implementing best-practice secrets management with key rotation and certificate handling, directly applicable to enterprise security posture
- Designed event-driven messaging pipelines using Azure Service Bus, Event Hub, and Event Grid to handle asynchronous workflows, real-time data ingestion, and decoupled microservice communication

- Configured observability and alerting via Azure Application Insights and Azure Monitor, tracking Failed Requests, Web Activity, and performance anomalies to support proactive incident response
- Managed cloud storage solutions including Azure Cosmos DB (with partitioning schemes and consistency levels), Azure Blob Storage (data archiving and retention policies), and Azure Queue Storage
- Deployed containerised workloads using Azure Container Registry and Azure Container Instances; provisioned and validated infrastructure using ARM templates for repeatable, secure deployments
- Implemented Azure API Management to secure and govern API access, configuring authentication policies and rate-limiting to enforce a defence-in-depth strategy
- Integrated Azure Redis Cache with encryption and expiration policies to optimise application performance whilst maintaining data security.

Agentic AI Hackathon, Microsoft Foundry (June 2026)

- Built multi-agent AI applications using Microsoft Foundry, Azure OpenAI and the Microsoft Agent Framework as part of Microsoft's Cloud & AI Frontier Week
- Orchestrated multi-agent workflows with Foundry IQ for multi-step business automation
- Attended live sessions across both days and completed the required projects to earn the AI Agent Master badge

Interactive CV Website (July 2026 - October 2026)

- https://portfolio-nine-roan-3b8pahbp36.vercel.app
- Built and deployed a personal site from scratch in Next.js 16, TypeScript and Tailwind CSS, statically prerendered on Vercel
- Hardened all responses with CSP, HSTS, Permissions-Policy, Referrer-Policy, frame-ancestors, nosniff and COOP, scoring grade A on securityheaders.com
- Defended the contact form in three layers: a validation schema shared by client and server, a honeypot that returns success rather than a validation error so bots gain no signal, and IP-based rate limiting applied before validation
- Published an RFC 9116 security.txt disclosure contact, and documented every engineering decision including known limitations in the public repository
- Wrote 14 unit tests and a GitHub Actions pipeline running lint, typecheck, test and build on every push

Certifications

Microsoft:

- AZ-204: Microsoft Certified Azure Developer Associate - App Service, Azure Functions, Key Vault, Azure AD, Service Bus, Event Hub, Event Grid, Cosmos DB, Blob Storage, Container Registry, APIM, Application Insights, Azure Monitor
- Agentic AI Hackathon: AI Agent Master (June 2026) - Microsoft Foundry, Azure OpenAI, Microsoft Agent Framework, Foundry IQ

IBM:

- IBM Cyber Threat Intelligence
- IBM Cybersecurity Analyst Assessment
- IBM Cybersecurity Capstone: Breach Response Case Studies
- IBM Penetration Testing, Incident Response and Forensics
- IBM Network Security & Database Vulnerabilities
- IBM Introduction to Cybersecurity Tools & Cyberattacks
- IBM Operating Systems: Overview, Administration and Security